

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 9 2
♥ A Q 8 4 3
♦ 10 8 7 2
♣ 9 4

♠ A 6 4

♥ 7 5 2

♦ A K Q

♣ K J 10 3

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ K 8 5 3

♥ K 6

♦ J 6 5 3

♣ A 7 2

♠ Q J 10 7

♥ J 10 9

♦ 9 4

♣ Q 8 6 5

West	North	East	South
	1NT	Pass	2♣
Pass	2♦	Pass	3NT

All Pass

3NT by North

Lead: ♠Q

♣Q so naturally you will finesse East. You dare not let East get into the lead since he can lead through dummy's ♥K. If West gets the lead with the ♣Q, he cannot hurt you.

Win the first trick with the ♠A. (**DO NOT HOLD UP, EAST MAY SWITCH**). Play the ♣K then ♣J, letting it ride if not covered. West can win the ♣Q but cannot lead a ♥ without giving you a trick. You win whatever else he returns and make your 9 tricks. Of course you must be careful to unblock the ♦ A K Q while you still have a dummy entry to the ♦J.

This is another hand where you want to keep a particular defender off lead. In this hand it is East who is the Danger hand.

Be on the lookout for this type of situation because many times you have a finesse that can be made either way. So you finesse into the Safe hand.

Balanced, 17 points. You open 1NT. Partner's response is 2♣.

Partner's 2♣ is Stayman. You have no 4-card Major to show so you bid 2♦. Partner now says 3NT and you pass.

North plays 3NT. East leads ♠Q.

North plays 3NT. East leads ♠Q.

Winners: ♠ 2 : ♥ 0 : ♦ 4 : ♣ 2 : Total = 8

The only thing better than being good is being lucky! You are very lucky that you didn't get a ♥ lead - now you must take advantage of your good luck.

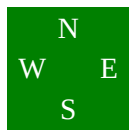
You only need one more winner, and the ♣ suit is your best bet. You can finesse either defender for the

Board 2

South Deals

None Vul

♠ K Q J 10 7 4 3	♠ A 9 6 2	♠ -
♥ 5	♥ A 8	♥ K 6 3
♦ Q 3	♦ A 8 7 6	♦ K J 10 9 4 2
♣ Q 7 5	♣ A 4 3	♣ 10 9 6 2



♠ 8 5
 ♥ Q J 10 9 7 4 2
 ♦ 5
 ♣ K J 8

West	North	East	South
3♠	4♥		3♥

All Pass

4♥ by South

Lead: ♠K

3-level, so if you play the ♠A East will ruff and one of your winners will disappear. So don't play the ♠A. Duck and let West win the trick while East shows out as expected. West will lead the ♠Q and you duck again. So West will lead the ♠J and you duck one more time, but now you can ruff in your hand.

Lead your ♥Q and finesse, East winning the ♥K. East will probably return a ♦ which you win in dummy. Play the ♥A. Then ruff a ♦ to get back to your hand and pull any trumps left out. Play a ♣ to dummy's ♣A and at long last play dummy's ♠A and discard your ♣ loser.

You always had 10 winners in this hand, as long as one of them didn't disappear.

To make sure the ♠A didn't disappear you had to hold it until East no longer had a trump.

You estimate your hand has 6 playing tricks. That is reasonable for a preemptive 3♥ bid. West overcalls 3♠ and partner bids 4♥. Everybody passes.

South plays 4♥. West leads the ♠K.

South plays 4♥. West leads the ♠K.

Losers: ♠ 1 : ♥ 1 : ♦ 0 : ♣ 1 : Total = 3

This looks way too easy. If the ♥ finesse works and the ♣ finesse works you could make 6. It is when things look too easy that you should look for danger! What if you play the ♠A and East ruffs. What if East also gets a trick with the ♥K and West gets a trick with the ♣Q. What with your ♠ loser you would be down 1.

West probably has a 7-card suit to overcall at the 3-level, so if you play the ♠A East will ruff and one of your winners will disappear. So don't play the ♠A. Duck and let West win the trick while East shows out as expected. West will lead the ♠Q and you duck again. So West will lead the ♠J and you duck one more time, but now you can ruff in your hand.

Board 3

South Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 6 5 2
♥ Q 10 7 3
♦ 7
♣ A 8 5 3 2

♠ K 8 7 3

♥ J 8 4 2

♦ 9 6 3

♣ K Q



♠ J 10 9 4
♥ 9 6 5
♦ J 8 5 4
♣ 9 4

♠ A Q

♥ A K

♦ A K Q 10 2

♣ J 10 7 6

West	North	East	South
			2♣
Pass	2NT	Pass	4♣
Pass	4♦	Pass	6NT
All Pass			

6NT by North

Lead: ♠J

assure 2 more ♦ tricks. There are lots of possibilities but you must be careful of entries and unblocking. In particular, you only have one entry to your hand (if you don't waste the ♠Q) and that is the ♣KQ. So you need to be sure to unblock the ♠AQ before you try to get to your hand in ♣s.

But there is something you **MUST** do first - test the ♦s. You win the ♠A and play ♦A, ♦K. West shows out on the second ♦! Now you unblock your ♠Q, then lead a ♣ to your ♣Q. Assume a defender takes the ♣A and plays a ♠. You win the ♠K, then the ♣K. Next a ♦ toward dummy, finessing East out of the ♦J. Dummy is now high.

What if you had carried out the plan up to the point when you led a ♣ toward your hand and the defense didn't take their ♣A?

You must abandon ♣s temporarily and take the ♦ finesse. You take your good ♦s and then go back to ♣s.

With 9 points opposite an opening 2♣ bid you are too strong for a negative response.

A suit response would promise a 5-card suit so you bid 2NT. Partner says 4♣.

Partner's jump to 4♣ over your 2NT is Gerber convention.

You have no Aces so you respond 4♦. Partner bids 6NT.

North to play 6NT. East leads the ♠J.

North to play 6NT. East leads the ♠J.

Winners: ♠ 3 : ♥ 2 : ♦ 3 : ♣ 0 : Total = 8

You need 4 more winners. The ♣ suit will provide 3 of them once the ♣A is gone. A 3-2 split in ♦s will

Board 4

South Deals

None Vul

♠ J 10 9 4

♥ J 9 3

♦ 10 9 3

♣ 8 5 2

♠ K 7 3

♥ K 8 4

♦ A K J

♣ K J 10 6



♠ 6 5 2

♥ Q 10 5

♦ Q 7 6 2

♣ 7 4 3

♠ A Q 8

♥ A 7 6 2

♦ 8 5 4

♣ A Q 9

West

North

East

South

Pass

6NT

All Pass

6NT by South

Lead: ♠ J

This one is definitely straightforward. You need to get one more winner. You can hope for a 3-3 ♥ split which would mean your fourth ♥ would become a winner, or you can hope that West has the ♦ Q in which case a simple finesse will give you the winner. But instead of making it an either/or situation you can combine your chances.

Win the first trick in either hand and duck a ♥. Win the return and play your 4 ♣ winners (discarding a ♦ from your hand) followed by your other 2 ♠ winners. Then play ♦ A, ♥ K and ♥ A. You will be in your hand with two cards - the ♥ 7 and the ♦ 8. If the ♥ 7 is good, cash it and win the last trick with dummy's ♦ K. If the ♥ 7 is not a winner then finesse the ♦ J.

Always be on the lookout for situations where there are two possible routes to success.

Here the ♦ finesse was one possibility, but by ducking a ♥ you could test the ♥ suit and still keep the ♦ finesse in reserve.

Partner has a balanced hand with 15-17 points. You have a balanced hand with 18 points. Together that makes two balanced hands with 33-35 points.

So you bid 6NT.

North would play 6NT.

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South plays 6NT. West leads the ♠ J.

South plays 6NT. West leads the ♠ J.

Winners: ♠ 3 : ♥ 2 : ♦ 2 : ♣ 4 : Total = 11

It's nice to make Plans for slams because there are so few losers to worry about.

Board 5

North Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 8
 ♥ K 7 5 4
 ♦ 10 8 6
 ♣ K 10 9 5 2

♠ A K 10 9 6 4

♥ J 10 3

♦ 9 5 2

♣ A



♠ 7 3 2
 ♥ A 8
 ♦ K Q J 3
 ♣ 8 7 4 3

♠ Q J 5

♥ Q 9 6 2

♦ A 7 4

♣ Q J 6

West	North	East	South
	1♠	Pass	2♥
Pass	2♠	Pass	3♠
Pass	4♠		
All Pass			

4♠ by North

Lead: ♦K

Win the ♦A and play the ♣6 to your ♣A. Play ♠A, then a small ♠ to dummy's ♠J. Lead the ♣Q. If West covers, ruff and re-enter dummy with a trump so you can discard a ♦ loser on the ♣J. If West doesn't cover the ♣Q when you lead it, discard a ♦ immediately. As long as West holds the ♣K you can make the contract. This is called a Ruffing Finesse.

In some hands there is more than one way to make the contract.

But in this deal the ruffing finesse is the only Plan that works.

You open 1♠ and partner responds 2♥.

With only 14 points and a 6-card suit you rebid a minimum 2♠. Partner raises to 3♠.

Your bids show 13-15 points. Partner has decided to invite you to bid game with a maximum. Since you have 14 points it's not really clear whether you should accept the invitation. You decide to add a little for your singleton Ace and bid 4♠.

North plays 4♠. East leads the ♦K.

North plays 4♠. East leads the ♦K.

Losers: ♠ 0 : ♥ 2 : ♦ 2 : ♣ 0 : Total = 4

The two fast losers in ♥s can't be helped, but maybe you can get rid of one of the ♦ losers.